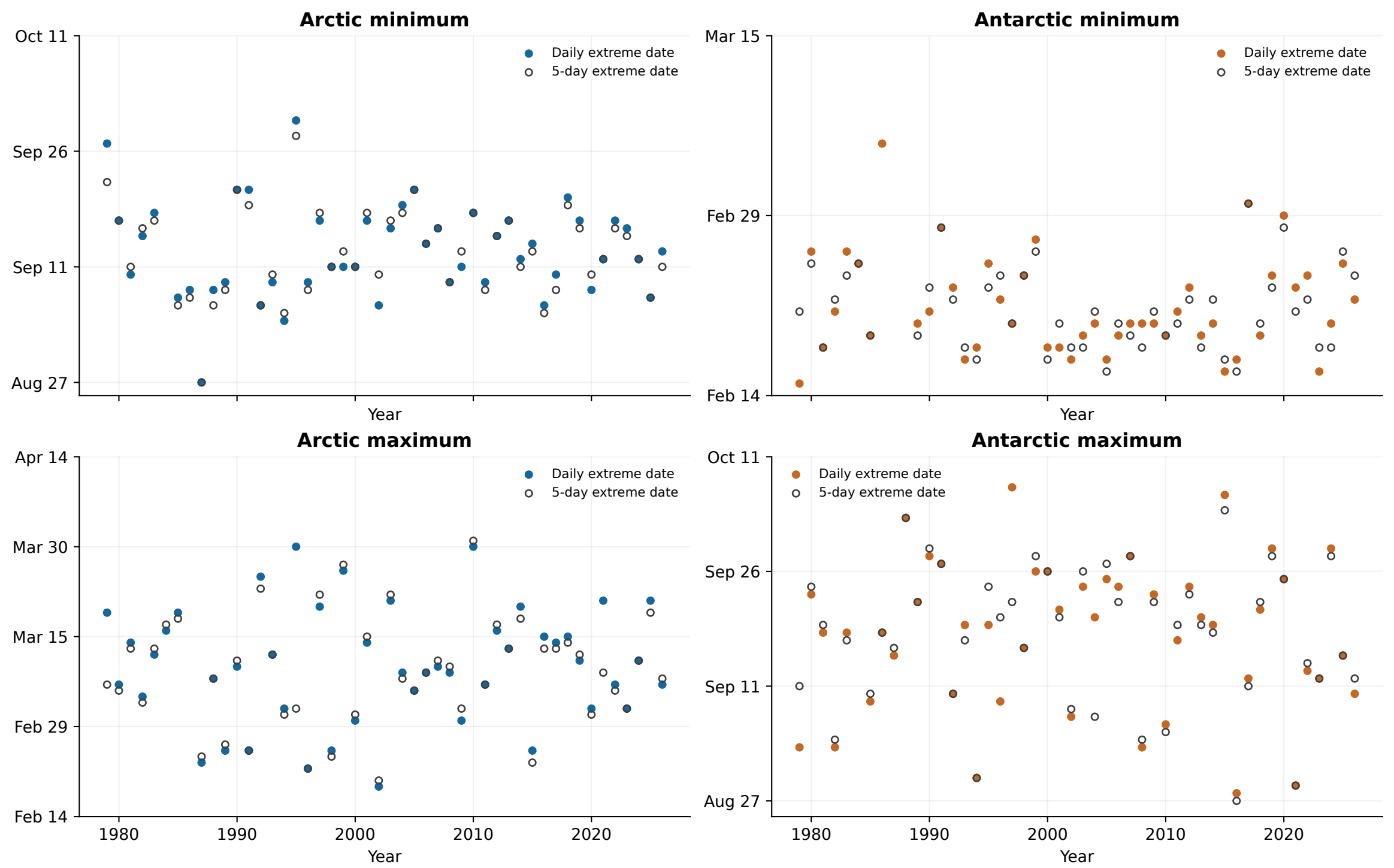

Dates use a fixed leap-year calendar. These are noisy extreme-date diagnostics, not a formal sea-ice phenology analysis.